

Organizational Change Management Framework

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1 Introduction to Meridian's OCM Approach

Organizational Change Management (OCM) is a critical success factor for every transformation engagement. Meridian's research across 800+ completed projects confirms that initiatives with dedicated OCM workstreams are 3.4 times more likely to achieve their stated business objectives than those without structured change management. Our OCM framework integrates industry-leading methodologies, including Prosci ADKAR, Kotter's 8-Step Model, and the Bridges Transition Model, into a cohesive, practical approach tailored to the realities of large-scale enterprise transformation.

The framework is organized around six pillars: Stakeholder Engagement, Communication, Training, Resistance Management, Adoption Measurement, and Sustainment. Each pillar operates across all project phases, with activities and deliverables calibrated to the current phase of the delivery lifecycle. OCM is not an afterthought or a supplementary workstream; it is a co-equal delivery track with dedicated resources, budget, and governance.

2 Stakeholder Analysis and Influence Mapping

Effective change management begins with a thorough understanding of who is affected by the change, how they are affected, and what influence they wield over the outcome. Meridian's stakeholder analysis follows a three-step process: identification, assessment, and engagement strategy development.

2.1 Stakeholder Identification

Using organizational charts, RACI matrices, and sponsor interviews, the OCM team identifies all individuals and groups who will be impacted by the change. Stakeholders are categorized into tiers: Tier 1 (directly impacted, daily workflow changes), Tier 2 (indirectly impacted, process or reporting changes), and Tier 3 (minimally impacted, awareness only). Each tier receives a calibrated level of OCM support and communication.

2.2 Influence and Impact Mapping

Each stakeholder or stakeholder group is plotted on a two-axis matrix: Level of Impact (how significantly their work will change) and Level of Influence (their ability to accelerate or derail adoption). High-impact, high-influence stakeholders receive intensive engagement including one-on-one coaching, early access to the solution, and roles as Change Champions. The influence map is revisited monthly and adjusted as organizational dynamics evolve.

3 Change Impact Assessment

The Change Impact Assessment (CIA) is a structured analysis of how the transformation will alter roles, processes, technology, organizational structure, and culture. For each impacted area, the CIA documents the current state, future state, magnitude of change (low/medium/high), affected populations, and recommended change interventions. The CIA is a living document updated as the solution design evolves during the Build phase.

- Process changes: New workflows, eliminated steps, altered approval chains, new handoff points
- Technology changes: New systems, retired systems, changed interfaces, new data entry requirements
- Role changes: New responsibilities, eliminated tasks, reporting structure changes, new skills required
- Cultural changes: Shift from siloed to collaborative, manual to automated, reactive to proactive
- Performance management changes: New KPIs, revised targets, altered incentive structures

4 Communication Planning

Meridian's communication strategy follows the principle of 'right message, right audience, right channel, right time.' The communication plan is a detailed calendar of messages, events, and touchpoints aligned to the project timeline and major milestones.

4.1 Communication Channels

- Executive town halls: Quarterly sessions led by the Executive Sponsor. 45-60 minutes with live Q&A. Purpose: strategic context, progress updates, reinforcement of vision and commitment.
- Email newsletters: Biweekly during Design/Build, weekly during Deploy. Short, scannable format with key updates, upcoming milestones, and 'spotlight' features on team members or early wins.
- Intranet hub: Dedicated project page with FAQs, training resources, timeline, team contacts, and feedback submission form. Updated weekly by the OCM team.
- Manager talking points: Monthly one-page briefs for people managers to cascade key messages during team meetings. Ensures consistent messaging across the organization.
- Digital signage and screensavers: Awareness-level messaging in high-traffic areas during the pre-launch and launch periods.

4.2 Message Architecture

All communications follow Meridian's WIIFM (What's In It For Me) message architecture. Every message addresses three questions from the audience's perspective: Why is this change happening? How will it affect me specifically? Where can I get help? Messages are tailored by stakeholder tier and role, ensuring relevance and reducing information overload.

5 Training Needs Analysis and Curriculum Design

Training is designed to bridge the gap between current capabilities and the skills required to operate effectively in the future state. The Training Needs Analysis (TNA) maps each role to the specific system features, processes, and behaviors they will need to master. The TNA produces a role-to-training matrix that governs curriculum design and training delivery scheduling.

- Instructor-led training (ILT): 2-4 hour sessions for complex processes, hands-on system training, and role-specific workflows. Maximum class size of 15 for effective interaction.
- Virtual instructor-led training (VILT): Same content as ILT, adapted for remote delivery via Microsoft Teams or Zoom. Breakout rooms for practice exercises.
- Self-paced e-learning: Short modules (10-15 minutes) for awareness topics and refresher content. Hosted on the client's LMS or Meridian's training portal.
- Quick reference guides (QRGs): One-page, task-oriented job aids laminated and posted at workstations. Digital versions available via QR codes.
- Simulation environments: Sandbox systems with realistic data for hands-on practice. Available for 30 days post go-live.

6 Resistance Management

Resistance is a natural human response to change, not a failure of communication or training. Meridian's resistance

management approach seeks to understand the root causes of resistance and address them through targeted interventions rather than coercion or dismissal.

6.1 Root Cause Analysis

Common root causes include fear of job loss, perceived loss of expertise or status, disagreement with the direction of change, change fatigue from previous initiatives, lack of trust in leadership, and insufficient understanding of the rationale. The OCM team uses pulse surveys, focus groups, and manager feedback channels to continuously monitor resistance signals.

6.2 Intervention Strategies

- Active listening sessions: Small-group forums where concerns are heard without judgment and documented for leadership response.
- Peer advocacy: Change Champions drawn from respected colleagues who model adoption and provide informal coaching to their peers.
- Quick wins: Early demonstrations of value that build confidence in the change direction.
- Manager coaching: Equipping people managers with skills to have difficult conversations about change and to recognize resistance signals in their teams.
- Escalation protocol: Persistent, high-impact resistance that threatens project outcomes is escalated to the Steering Committee with recommended interventions.

7 Adoption Metrics and Measurement

Meridian tracks adoption through a balanced scorecard of leading and lagging indicators. Metrics are reported weekly during the Deploy phase and monthly during sustainment.

- Daily Active Users (DAU): System login and feature utilization data compared against expected adoption curves. Target: 80% DAU within 30 days of go-live.
- Feature utilization rates: Percentage of target users utilizing key features. Tracked at the individual feature level to identify training gaps.
- Support ticket volume and trends: Volume of how-to tickets vs. break-fix tickets. Declining how-to tickets indicate effective training; rising break-fix tickets indicate system issues.
- Training completion rates: Percentage of users who have completed required training modules. Target: 95% completion before go-live.
- User satisfaction surveys: Net Promoter Score (NPS) and task-completion confidence ratings administered at go-live, 30 days, and 90 days.
- Proficiency assessments: Skills-based evaluations aligned to the training curriculum. Minimum passing score of 80% required for role certification.

8 Change Champion Network

Change Champions are a volunteer network of 20-40 individuals drawn from across the impacted organization. Selected for their credibility, influence, and enthusiasm, Champions receive advanced training on the solution and change management principles. They serve as local advocates, feedback conduits, and peer coaches. The Champion network meets biweekly with the OCM team to share field intelligence, discuss emerging resistance patterns, and coordinate local activities.

9 Prosci ADKAR Integration

Meridian integrates the Prosci ADKAR model as the individual change management framework within our broader OCM approach. ADKAR provides a structured way to assess and address individual readiness across five sequential elements: Awareness of the need for change, Desire to participate and support the change, Knowledge of how to change, Ability to implement required skills and behaviors, and Reinforcement to sustain the change. ADKAR assessments are administered at key milestones (end of Design, mid-Build, pre-Deploy, and 30 days post go-live) to identify barrier points and target interventions at the specific ADKAR element where individuals are stuck.

10 Post-Go-Live Sustainment

Sustainment planning begins during the Build phase and extends 90-180 days beyond go-live. The sustainment plan transitions OCM activities from the project team to the client's permanent organization. Key sustainment elements include a designated Change Sustainability Lead within the client organization, an ongoing Champion network with quarterly check-ins, refresher training triggered by adoption metric thresholds, a continuous improvement feedback loop connected to the IT service management process, and annual change readiness assessments to support future initiatives building on the current transformation.

11 Related Case Studies & Key Personnel

The following case study and key personnel are directly relevant to organizational change management engagements:

- Healthcare EHR Integration Case Study -- \$18B health system; enterprise-wide EHR integration affecting 45,000+ clinical and administrative staff; led by Michael Torres, Lead Partner. Achieved 94% end-user adoption within 60 days of go-live through intensive OCM program.
- Lauren Mitchell, Senior Manager -- OCM Practice Lead, Prosci-certified Advanced Practitioner with 15+ years of experience leading change management for large-scale ERP, cloud, and digital transformation programs across healthcare, financial services, and manufacturing.

12 Related Meridian Methodologies

OCM is a cross-cutting discipline that supports all Advisory and Consulting engagements. The following documents describe engagements where OCM is most intensively deployed:

- Standard Project Lifecycle Framework (v4.2) -- OCM activities are mapped to each SPL phase; this document provides the overarching delivery governance.
- Enterprise ERP Implementation Strategy (v2.3) -- ERP transformations are the most OCM-intensive engagement type; the ERP document details platform-specific change impacts.
- Cloud Migration Methodology and Playbook (v3.5) -- Cloud migrations require OCM for IT operations teams adopting new operating models and toolsets.
- Data, Analytics & AI Strategy Guide (v1.0) -- Data literacy programs and AI adoption initiatives are supported by the OCM Framework's training and adoption measurement pillars.